

# THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: DJIA 51947.25 ▼ 199.17 0.38% NASDAQ 24975.82 ▼ 2.1% STOXX 600 644.51 ▲ 0.5% 10-YR. TREASURY ▼ 1 2/32, yield 4.678% OIL \$89.31 ▲ \$7.53 EURO \$1.1371 YEN 163.85

## What's News

### Business & Finance

- ◆ **Nvidia is in talks to** provide a roughly \$250 billion backstop for OpenAI as part of a massive data center project, one of the most ambitious financial transactions yet in America's AI boom. **A1**
- ◆ **United Airlines**, hunting for a megadeal, last year approached Delta about a merger that would have combined the two most valuable U.S. carriers. **A1**
- ◆ **A shift toward more** hiring is emerging across U.S. industries from railroads to tech as companies plan to add workers to meet growth goals or to seize on emerging technologies. **A1**
- ◆ **Stocks face major tests** this week from tech earnings and the Fed's interest-rate decision against a back drop of notable declines over the previous two weeks. **B1**
- ◆ **David Fox**, who helped build Kirkland & Ellis into a top law firm, now sees artificial intelligence as the profession's future. **B1**
- ◆ **A surge in popularity** of Hasbro's Magic card game has bucked the trend of declining sales of traditional toys, energizing the company. **B3**
- ◆ **Spirits maker Sazerac** sent a letter to a group of Brown-Forman shareholders asking them to reconsider a \$15 billion buy-out offer that was rebuffed. **B3**
- ◆ **Elon Musk's tunneling** startup, the Boring Company, is in talks to raise new funding that would value it at around \$20 billion. **B4**
- ◆ **More businesses** are transferring claims to tariff refunds they might be due as they grow concerned that payouts may not, in fact, appear. **B3**

### Worldwide

- ◆ **Trump put off** an escalation of his military campaign against Iran amid efforts to revive diplomacy to open the Strait of Hormuz and a debate over the impact of declining munitions stocks. **A1**
- ◆ **Attacks between** Saudi Arabia and Houthi rebels in Yemen are escalating, threatening to break a fragile truce that has held for four years. **A6**
- ◆ **Former Maine state** Senate President Troy Jackson secured the Democratic nomination for the U.S. Senate following Graham Platner's decision to abandon his scandal-plagued campaign. **A4**
- ◆ **A warning by the** Wisconsin Elections Commission opened a new front in the escalating legal battle between prediction markets and the state regulators fighting to ban them. **A5**
- ◆ **At least 40 million** people were under extreme heat warnings across central and southern parts of the U.S. in conditions of high temperatures and severe humidity. **A2**
- ◆ **India's education minister** resigned, handing the country's youth movement a victory and showing the growing heft of protests that began months ago as online memes. **A8**
- ◆ **Brazil denied visas** to two Trump administration officials who planned to travel there amid concerns they sought to undermine confidence in the country's electronic-voting system. **A9**
- ◆ **North Korean leader** Kim Jong Un called for "radical" enhancements to the country's military reconnaissance and intelligence capabilities, state media reported. **A8**

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## Tour de France Champion Makes History



**SPIN AND WIN:** Slovenian Tadej Pogacar, 27, rolled onto the Champs-Élysées to claim his fifth Tour de France on Sunday, making him one of only five men to win bicycling's biggest race five times. Pogacar won by six minutes and 26 seconds. **A18**

## Nvidia in Talks to Back OpenAI On \$250 Billion for Data Hub

Ohio project, tied to U.S. deal, would be one of world's largest computing centers

Nvidia is in talks to provide a roughly \$250 billion backstop for OpenAI as part of a massive data center project, one of the most ambitious financial transactions yet in the artificial-intelligence boom.

The guarantees from Nvidia would help the Chat-

GPT maker lease a 10-giga-watt project that SoftBank's energy subsidiary is developing in southern Ohio, people familiar with the matter said. In total, the project could cost more than \$500 billion, including the chips that would go inside the data centers. It would be the largest data center project announced to date.

The power for the project is controlled by the U.S. government and funded separately by Japan under a recent trade deal. Commerce

By Anissa Gardizy, Amrith Ramkumar and Corrie Driebusch

Secretary Howard Lutnick is involved in deciding who will get the power, some of the people said.

Nvidia's backing would allow the data center developer, which is owned by Japanese billionaire Masayoshi Son's investment firm SoftBank, to raise debt at more favorable terms than it could if OpenAI had no financial

backer, since OpenAI has no investment-grade credit rating as an unprofitable private company. The AI company has been in advanced talks to lease the site for several weeks, people familiar with the matter said.

OpenAI is among the companies that have shown most interest in the site, while Anthropic, Microsoft and Google have also spoken to Lutnick about it in recent weeks, one of the people said.

AI companies are desperate  
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## Deadly Attack In Berlin

People gathered Sunday in front of the Brandenburg Gate after a vehicle attack on a pride festival the previous day left at least one person dead and dozens injured. The suspect was killed Sunday evening by police. **A9**



CHRISTOPH SUEDE/DPZ/UMA PRESS

## Hiring Defies Forecast of AI Wipeout

By CHIP CUTTER

America's biggest companies say they might need more people after all.

For months, major employers treated hiring as an expensive last resort. Now, a shift is emerging across industries. Companies ranging from railroad giant CSX to Google parent Alphabet have told investors in recent days that they plan to hire to meet growth goals or to seize on emerging technologies.

The push to expand headcount, at least modestly, is a reversal from the prevailing corporate messaging during much of the AI era. Major employers largely held back on adding people due to economic uncertainties or a belief that artificial intelligence could shoulder more tasks on the job. But some executives say the costs and limitations of AI now demand that more people be added; others want to hire people back following layoffs. "We actually need to accel-

erate hiring a bit. We're a little bit behind right now," Booz Allen Hamilton's chief operating officer, Kristine Martin Anderson, told investors on Friday. "We're addressing that now."

The government contractor cut thousands of jobs last year as the Trump administration slashed federal contracts and asked firms to justify their costs. Total headcount stood at roughly 30,900 as of June 30, down 7.5% from a  
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## Chatbots Answer Perilous Queries

AI models know how to make biological weapons. Some will teach you.

By GEORGIA WELLS AND AMRITH RAMKUMAR

After OpenAI enhanced the brain power of its chatbot last summer, hundreds of users worldwide began asking it how to make and deploy biological weapons and poisons.

The models, operating largely free of U.S. government restrictions, patiently answered, issuing step-by-step instructions described by company employees as simple enough for a high-school biology student to follow. Biology and terrorism experts later reviewed the exchanges for ChatGPT and judged some as deadly accurate, said people familiar with the matter.

Most queries were about concocting poisons, according to OpenAI.

OpenAI banned these and other user accounts that asked about how to make poisons and biological weapons, but it didn't alert law-enforcement officials. The U.S. has no federal laws requiring AI companies to either restrict or disclose queries about making weapons or formulating plans that pose a safety threat.

The absence of mandated safeguards coincides with a rise in queries from users asking AI models how to kill en masse—and chatbots responding with credible plans  
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## United Approached Delta About a Merger

By ALISON SIDER AND ANDREW TANGEL

United Airlines, on the hunt for a megadeal, last year approached Delta Air Lines about a merger that would have combined the two most valuable U.S. carriers, according to people familiar with the matter.

As part of the pitch, United Chief Executive Scott Kirby made a call to Delta CEO Ed Bastian, some of the people said.

Delta leaders discussed the approach and merits of a potential deal as part of preliminary due diligence, people familiar with the matter said. The talks didn't progress, and both companies later moved on from the proposal, they said.

The outreach, which hadn't previously been reported, underscores Kirby's appetite for taking big swings in pursuit of his global ambitions for United. His later attempt to engage in merger talks with American Airlines, which American rebuffed, also became public earlier this year.

United and Delta are among four giants that have come to dominate the U.S. airline industry after a series of mergers over the past two decades. Industry officials have long believed that any merger between those carriers would be impossible because of antitrust concerns.

But business leaders in many industries were hopeful that big deals—even some that would have been unthinkable  
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### A Mystery Consumes a Golf Course: Who Turned the Grass Orange?

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All 18 greens and a practice putting surface at Michigan's course were attacked

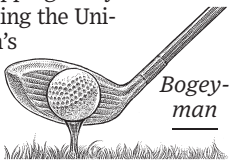
By RYAN FELTON

ANN ARBOR, Mich.—Golfers here have been chipping away at a scandal encircling the University of Michigan's

renowned course: It was clearly a communist plot. Then again, maybe it was the handiwork of fans of rivals Ohio State and Michigan State. Jokes aside, Michigan has a

mystery on its hands: How did all 18 greens of its beloved track suddenly turn orange?

The university disclosed the issue this month in an urgent email soliciting tips about an "unexpected issue" affecting the course's greens. "Over the last few days, we have experienced an unforeseen and highly unusual  
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Bogeyman

### INSIDE



**U.S. NEWS**  
Disease-bearing ticks threaten the Midwest as they expand into new areas. **A3**